COURSE

OCR A Level Business (H431)

Leadership and management

Human resources · Management and leadership: Leadership

Revision for Human resources: each firm works it out on its own deals.

Class	Topic
OCR A Level Business (H431 / H436)	**Leadership and management**

THE LESSON

Setup — 3 min

Round 1 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min

- Firm decisions
- Deals
- TASK 1 — Blake-Mouton: why
- TASK 2 — Autocratic effects

Round 2 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min

- Firm decisions
- Deals
- TASK 3 — Continuum in order
- TASK 4 — Error rate rise
- B2B deal

Round 3 — Decisions 3 min · Deals 5 min · Topic tasks 4 min · B2B deal 3 min

- Firm decisions
- Deals
- TASK 5 — New team, deadline
- TASK 6 — Style and the fix
- B2B deal

Final questions — 3 min

Fits a 30-minute lesson setting; longer settings add more deals.

Each step

Firm decisions	Each role makes its decision on its own page.
Deals	Each pupil trades with a classmate in another firm.
Topic task	The firm answers together. Everyone presses Agree.
B2B deal	One firm sells a lot of cars to another firm.
Final questions	Each pupil answers six questions.

Firm decisions

CEO	**Staff**	Hire staff. Each costs a salary and gives one benefit.
	Sabotage FROM ROUND 2	Hit a rival firm's cash, at a cost. A Legal Counsel blocks it.
Sales & Marketing	**Marketing**	Book one advert campaign to lift the next sales.
Finance	**Capital & Loans**	Borrow cash. The firm pays it back with interest.
	Investments FROM ROUND 2	Buy property or funds. The value can rise or fall.
Operations	**Seasonal stock**	Order the season's cars in advance.

B2B deal · Rounds 2 and 3

One firm sells a lot of 3 cars to another firm (4 in Round 3). With an odd number of firms, two firms offer to sell and the lower price wins.

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same for every firm.

Task 1

ROUND 1

Targets are always met, but morale is low and staff quit. The manager cares only about targets.

Using Blake-Mouton, what best explains this?

PICK ONE

- ○ High concern for people, low for sales
- ✔ **High concern for sales, low for people**
- ○ Low concern for both
- ○ Medium concern for both

Why: High concern for production and low for people is authority-compliance (9,1).

Task 2

ROUND 1

A manager decides everything alone and gives orders.

Which two effects are most likely over time?

PICK TWO

- ○ Decisions take longer
- ✔ **Fast decisions in a crisis**
- ✔ **Skilled staff feel undervalued**
- ○ Staff feel more involved
- ○ Staff gain more responsibility

Why: Deciding alone is quick, but skilled staff want a say.

Task 3

ROUND 2

Four points on the Tannenbaum-Schmidt continuum.

Order them, boss-centred first?

PUT THESE IN ORDER, FIRST TO LAST · RIGHT ORDER

1. **Tells: decides and announces**
2. **Sells: decides, then persuades**
3. **Consults: asks, then decides**
4. **Delegates: the team decides**

Why: Along the continuum the manager uses less authority and staff gain freedom.

Task 4

ROUND 2

A new laissez-faire manager took over.

Rise in the error rate, as a %?

WORK OUT THE NUMBER, THEN PICK IT · EXAMPLE FIGURES

Deals a month	**200 deals**
Pricing errors before	**16 errors**
Pricing errors now	**24 errors**

METHOD

Rise % = (errors now − errors before) ÷ errors before × 100

(24 − 16) ÷ 16 × 100 = 50%

Why: Little direction suits skilled staff; here errors rose by 50%.

Task 5

ROUND 3

A new, untrained team must deliver a big fleet order by Friday.

Which approach fits, and why?

PICK A OR B AND GIVE A REASON

- ✔ **Clear instructions from the manager**
- ○ Let the team decide how

Why: Untrained staff and little time need clear direction.

Task 6

ROUND 3

Sales fall and staff leave. The manager neither sets targets nor talks to staff.

Which style is this, and which should it move to?

PICK ONE

- ○ Country club → authority-compliance
- ○ Impoverished → country club
- ✔ **Impoverished → team management**
- ○ Middle of the road → team management

Why: Low concern for both is impoverished; Blake and Mouton see team management as best.

Final questions

6
questions for each pupil

109
Level 3 Business questions

2
of them on leadership and management

The game draws 6 of the 109 Level 3 questions; these 2 are about leadership and management.

1 A dealer says managers welcome challenge, but staff say every failed decision is punished. Which cultural effect is most likely?

Staff stop raising risks or new ideas.

2 A safety incident at a branch needs immediate coordinated action. Why might a usually participative leader become more directive for now?

Urgent risk needs fast, clear decisions.